

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Lawmakers OK transit overhaul

‘Transformational’ \$1.5B bill creates body to oversee Chicago-area public transportation, hikes tolls

By Olivia Olander, Talia Soglin and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — With the clock ticking down to avert an impending public transit fiscal cliff, Illinois Democrats in the predawn hours Friday muscled through a \$1.5 billion plan that diverts revenue from the state’s road fund and state motor fuel sales tax to mass

transit, likely raises another sales tax in the Chicago region and significantly hikes fares on the Illinois Tollway.

The measure, which supporters called historic, overhauls the Chicago region’s mass transit system by creating the Northern Illinois Transit Authority, a new governing body to oversee the Chicago Transit Authority, Metra and Pace.

But while the last-minute legislation was lauded for not including the broad taxes that tanked previous versions, its redirection of funds now used statewide for road construction was summarily slammed by incensed downstate Republicans who argued they and their constituents were getting the short end of the bargain.

Just after 4:15 a.m. Friday, the Senate approved the bill 36-21

with nearly all Democrats voting in favor. That was about three hours after House Democrats OK’d the legislation with 72 votes to the GOP’s 32. Democrats hold supermajorities in both chambers, and the bill now heads to the desk of Gov. JB Pritzker, who signaled in a statement Friday that he’d sign the measure into law.

“The legislation makes important changes to how Illinois

operates and manages our transportation network, including investing in new capital projects that will make our public transit and tollways more modern, efficient, and reliable for riders,” Pritzker said in the statement. “I am pleased the legislation also avoids new broad-based state taxes on Illinois working families.”

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Judges rule SNAP funds must continue

RI, Mass. decisions on food program come amid federal shutdown

By Michael Casey, Geoff Mulvihill and Kimberlee Kruesi
Associated Press

BOSTON — Two federal judges ruled nearly simultaneously on Friday that President Donald Trump’s administration must continue to fund SNAP, the nation’s biggest food aid program, using contingency funds during the government shutdown.

The judges in Massachusetts and Rhode Island gave the administration leeway on whether to fund the program partially or in full for November.

The rulings came a day before the U.S. Department of Agriculture planned to freeze payments to the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program because it said it could no longer keep funding it due to the shutdown.

The program serves about 1 in 8 Americans and is a major piece of the nation’s social safety net — and it costs about \$8 billion per month nationally.

Trump posted on social media Friday blasting Democrats for the shutdown and suggesting the government would comply with the rulings but also that it needed

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Legislature OKs bill to allow medical aid in dying

Bill narrowly passes that would make Illinois latest ‘right to die’ state

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Illinois stands to become the next state that would permit doctors to help terminally ill people end their lives after the controversial measure cleared its final legislative hurdle early Friday in a narrow state Senate vote in which opponents questioned the bill’s morality and one said it could bring “a culture of death” to the state.

The bill will go to Gov. JB Pritzker, who will have to decide whether to sign it into law. If he does, the legislation would allow mentally competent, terminally ill adults the right to access life-ending prescription medication. The governor’s office did not return a request for comment about whether Pritzker backs the legislation.

If signed by Pritzker, Illinois would join at least 10 other states,

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BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Detentions grip area on Halloween

Border Patrol agents detain painter Krzysztof Klim while verifying his identification Friday next to Halloween decorations outside a house in Chicago’s Edison Park neighborhood. Klim, originally from Poland and now a U.S. citizen, was briefly detained and then released. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



ICE detainee released, reunited with daughter fighting cancer

Ruben Torres Maldonado returns home late Thursday to his wife, sick daughter and 4-year-old son after nearly two weeks in ICE custody. The 40-year-old Portage Park man’s 16-year-old daughter, Ofelia, is undergoing cancer treatment. Maldonado’s arrest at a Home Depot and the government’s refusal to allow him out on bond while his case is ongoing drew intense scrutiny from public officials who said it was cruel. An immigration judge ordered him released from an Indiana jail on Thursday and he was home that night. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Carti energized in Chicago

Rapper Playboi Carti’s “Antagonist 2.0” tour packs the United Center with 25,000 fans for a long night of music featuring several artists with loyal fan bases. **Arts & Living**

Swift to sit out for Bears

The Bears ruled out D’Andre Swift for Sunday’s game against the Bengals with a groin injury. Backup Roschon Johnson also was ruled out after suffering a back injury. **Chicago Sports**

Neglect alleged at Broadview ICE center

Class-action lawsuit claims conditions at facility are inhumane

By Madeline Buckley and Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

A 56-year-old widower, a single parent and sole caretaker for four U.S. citizen children, had secured an immigration court date with a good case for being granted bail, according to his attorney.

But despite entering the U.S. legally and securing a work permit, a lawsuit alleges, immigration agents made the man sign a voluntary departure waiver while he was housed in allegedly inhumane conditions at the west suburban Broadview holding facility.

Later that day, he was “on the other side of the border.”

The man’s case is detailed in a sweeping class-action lawsuit filed on Thursday against immigration officials, alleging dirty and unsafe conditions at the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview where they say arrestees are being warehoused for days on end.

The complaint, filed in federal court in Chicago, also accuses

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TODAY’S WEATHER



High 49 Low 36

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 305 © Chicago Tribune

